

The Glorified Body - 6

The Resurrection Puzzle Needed More Than a Creed

As far as I know, I am going to get to teach. I do believe we are going to make it to Thessalonians, so put a marker there. Meanwhile, let us go to a couple of places in passing and review the foundation again.

Go to Isaiah 26 and put your finger there, and then go to Matthew 27. We will read a couple of verses, then go over to Isaiah 26 for one verse.

We have been teaching on the resurrection. I would not have really tackled this subject by myself because there were too many pieces missing from the puzzle. I did not know how to approach it or where to go to get the information. Even at times when I thought, "One of these days I am going to assimilate the resurrection," I looked over the material to assimilate and could not see the answers there. So I thought, "I had better put this off."

Finally, from praying in tongues, when it came time for the resurrection limb, He put it on. As you remember, it started with whether babies are born spiritually dead or alive. Then we got into finding that out, and it opened more questions. It kept escalating until we found ourselves being raptured or something in the resurrection.

Bronk remembers, three years ago, riding down a hill with me from Gatlinburg. We were talking about some of these things, and he was asking questions. I had to tell him, "I do not know."

He said, "Yes, but what if our body is blown up?"

I said, "Well, no, you are going to get a glorified body. I just do not know how."

Then I thought, "I will figure this out. The first time I got a body, my mother gave it to me. They hauled produce in from all over the world, she bought food out of the market, and that is what I was made out of. So if He gathered me from the whole face of the planet once, I guess He could do it again if a shark ate me."

That was my reasoning. If He gathered me the first time and sent me through a single double strand of DNA, He could do it again. If I was blown up by an atom bomb, I guess He could find the atoms I was made out of, glorify them, and put them back into a body.

I just could not see much sense in it. Yet He is coming back, and He talks about things like the dead in Christ rising first, and the bodies of the saints being seen walking around in Jerusalem. There were all these pieces to the puzzle that I just could not seem to put together.

I thank God.

Father, with all my heart I glorify You and thank You for that Teacher in the person of the Holy Spirit. Because He lives big in us, we do not have to take creeds and doctrines whose origin is with man. We have access to Your best. The commission is to guide us into all truth, and Your word is truth. We yield ourselves to You. We are thirsty and hungry, Father, for these things. As Your children, we give You all the praise, honor, and glory.

Everybody said amen.

Matthew Records Bodies Raised as Witnesses in Jerusalem

We had a resurrection that happened after Christ came out of the grave. Matthew says the bodies of many of the saints who slept were seen and appeared to many in Jerusalem.

Looking at this account again, we had some kind of resurrection the day Jesus came out of the grave. Matthew 27:51 says:

And, behold, the veil of the temple was rent in twain from the top to the bottom; and the earth did quake, and the rocks rent.

On the day this was written, many of the prophets and others would have been entombed the same way Jesus was. So when the next verse says what it says, it tells you what rocks were rent. "And" is a conjunction that ties these thoughts together.

There was an earthquake. The veil in the temple was rent from top to bottom. The earth quaked. The rocks rent. And the graves were opened.

So it tells you the rocks that broke open were the ones that opened the graves.

Matthew continues:

And the graves were opened; and many bodies of the saints which slept arose, and came out of the graves after his resurrection, and went into the holy city, and appeared unto many.

It is interesting how he puts this, because he wanted you to know it was their bodies that came out.

It is almost as if Matthew had a second thought here. None of the others recorded this. Matthew did. It is almost as if he put it in at the very end. Jesus died, was crucified, and then Matthew jumps ahead to His resurrection. He has to say, "after His resurrection." They came out of the graves after His resurrection, went into the holy city, and appeared to many.

I have heard preachers say the most they ever say about that verse: there was a lot of confusion going around. A lot had just happened. Many of the old saints who slept in the old covenant had risen and were walking around, testifying of the resurrection.

I could accept that. I just did not know what God did with them after His ascension.

If they were resurrected in their glorified bodies, were they supposed to have one yet? Nobody seemed to know whether we get a glorified body now, or when Jesus comes back, or at the end of this dispensation. So what did He do with them? Did He send them back into the tombs, unrent the rocks, and leave their bodies lying there while taking their spirits with Him?

Where did they go?

If they were resurrected in their natural bodies, did He glorify them with Himself and then go on up into heaven?

He told Mary not to touch Him. He said He had not yet ascended, meaning the final offering had not yet been given and could not be touched. Later He said, "Touch the holes in My hands." So we know He came back in His glorified body and walked down the road talking with them, and still they did not recognize who He was until the whole thing was over.

This glorified body must have some power to it. Jesus could keep them from recognizing Him, and He still had the nail scars in His hands. I can understand that with Him, but what did He do with these people?

Did He take them back with Him, glorified? Or did their bodies lie back down and deteriorate while He took their spirits to wait until the day He gives us glorified bodies?

Those questions were in me for years.

Romans and Isaiah Point to a Firstfruits Resurrection

We found out from Romans 8 and 1 Corinthians 15 that there was a resurrection. Romans 8 talks about two dispensations. So does 1 Corinthians 15.

Romans 8 talks about our advent. Then it switches and says, "those He foreknew." It talks about those before the cross being predestinated to be conformed to His image, that He might be the firstborn among many brethren.

Firstborn means there was not one born before Him. The whole human race was in spiritual death. He was the firstborn out of it.

Those He foreknew, He predestinated to be conformed to His image. Those He foreknew, He called. Those He called to the cross, He justified at the cross. Then it says, "and those He justified, He also glorified."

That is talking strictly about their dispensation: those He beforehand knew, or foreknew. The whole earth waited in predestination for that one event.

So we had some kind of resurrection in that day. The ones directly connected with Jesus' resurrection obviously went down and were seen of many. They were probably not just seen; they were a testimony. They testified of His resurrection.

There were many saints who slept, probably directly connected with the promise and waiting for it. They probably knew what was coming. They were the ones who came out and testified of it.

Now go back for a moment to Isaiah 26. We have an interesting prophecy in verse 19. I like the wording on this. That is a good awakening. You wake up singing.

Thy dead men shall live, together with my dead body shall they arise. Awake and sing, ye that dwell in dust: for thy dew is as the dew of herbs, and the earth shall cast out the dead.

Then verse 20 says:

Come, my people, enter thou into thy chambers, and shut thy doors about thee: hide thyself as it were for a little moment, until the indignation be overpast.

Is that not interesting?

We know there was a resurrection. Isaiah addresses it: together with my dead body, they shall arise. Many rose that day and testified of it.

Christ Harvested the Firstfruits Before Our Dispensation

Go to 1 Corinthians 15. Just like Romans 8, Paul divides two dispensations here and takes it all the way back to Adam. Follow the wording very closely.

First Corinthians 15:20 says:

But now is Christ risen from the dead, and become the firstfruits of them that slept.

We are not talking just spiritually dead. These people were separated from their bodies by death. He was the firstfruits of them that slept.

Paul goes on:

For since by man came death, by man came also the resurrection of the dead.

Then he takes it all the way back to Adam:

For as in Adam all die, even so in Christ shall all be made alive.

Now verse 23 is dispensational:

But every man in his own order: Christ the firstfruits; afterward they that are Christ's at his coming.

That is what Paul is talking about in verse 20. Christ is risen from the dead and became the firstfruits of them that slept, all those who died waiting for the promise.

We knew He emptied out Abraham's bosom. We knew He emptied out the place where they were kept in the promise God made to Adam, that Satan's head would be bruised by the seed of a woman, which was speaking of Christ. We know the promise He made even to Noah concerning sacrifice. Noah was operating in that promise until God visited Abraham.

In this dispensation, He emptied them out all the way back to Adam.

But the question we are dealing with is this: was it just their spirits that went back to await our dispensation for a glorified body? At the end of our dispensation, when He returns and we get glorified bodies, does Adam have to wait for that one?

Did they come out of their graves with glorified bodies?

Romans 8 says so. Those He called, He justified at the cross. First, they were predestinated to it. They had to wait for the Firstborn. They were called to that event. At the cross they were justified. Those justified at the cross were also glorified.

He was the firstfruits of them that slept. According to Matthew, what kind of logic would it be to take those men out of their graves and then put them back?

There was no documented record all over the world that suddenly, everywhere, people came out of graves. The only place it seemed to happen, where men belonging to the old dispensation came out of their graves, was in the holy city. Together with His dead body, they rose and testified. Their testimony had something to do with witnessing the resurrection and with being connected to the promises.

There is not a lot written about this, probably because most translators just could not handle it. They did not know how to translate any of that in.

If an event like that had happened worldwide, from Adam until then, with all these glorified people running around on the planet for the duration Christ was here, you would think scholars and historians would have documented it somewhere. But the only place we have it is here in Matthew.

I understand it now because I finally understood the end of our advent. The dead in Christ rise first, and we who are alive and remain shall be changed in a moment, in the twinkling of an eye. We will be wearing these bodies, and they will go from corruptible to incorruptible. We shall be changed. In that moment, we will be caught up.

There used to be an old song called "A Meeting in the Clouds."

The only Old Testament saints seen were the ones raised with Him who went into Jerusalem, directly connected with Him, and testified. But that advent is very clear. It goes back to Adam: in Adam all die, and in Christ all are made alive. First Christ was made alive, then the firstfruits.

Did they come out with their glorified bodies? According to Romans 8, the documentation in Matthew 27, and now the documentation in 1 Corinthians 15, yes. Christ and the firstfruits. Afterward, us at His coming. This will happen to us at the end of our advent, at the sound of the trump, when He comes back to get us.

When we get to Thessalonians, we will be able to answer why nobody else saw the resurrection of the firstfruits worldwide. Nobody saw it. Part of the glorification of the saints took place in the clouds. The other part took place here on the ground.

Just like part of that glorification took place here: the rocks were rent. Whoever those saints testified to could say, "This man rose from the dead, and these old prophets, these who prophesied and carried the promise, rose with Him." But worldwide, there is no documentation.

When we are glorified, two will be in the field; one taken, one left. The world will know something happened because it will be testified all over the world. We will be glorified right in front of the people left behind. Something happened. We were taken up.

But all the rest of the saints who slept before us will not be seen glorified in front of people's eyes. They will be glorified in the clouds when He comes through. The rest of the world from that first advent obviously was caught up in His ascension and glorified along the way in the clouds, just like those who are coming back. They rise first, and we who are alive and remain are glorified in a moment, in the twinkling of an eye. One left in the field, one taken right in front of their eyes, then caught up for the greatest reunion in the history of the world.

All your relatives will be there.

So part of it took place in the clouds, just like in the first event. There was a group that was seen, but the rest of the world from Adam forward ascended and was glorified in the clouds, leaving no record behind, and obviously went on to heaven to be with Him.

This gets interesting. Otherwise, people cannot explain Matthew 27. It only took me thirty years.

Paul Answers What Body the Dead Are Raised With

Let us take some prime verses out of 1 Corinthians 15 again.

Verse 20 says:

But now is Christ risen from the dead, and become the firstfruits of them that slept.

These all died waiting on the promise.

Verse 21 says:

For since by man came death, by man came also the resurrection of the dead.

That takes it all the way back to Adam.

Verse 22 says:

For as in Adam all die, even so in Christ shall all be made alive.

Then:

But every man in his own order: Christ the firstfruits; afterward they that are Christ's at his coming.

Christ and those who slept before the cross are the firstfruits. He has already harvested the firstfruits. We are the second dispensation. He is going to come and get us at His coming.

But the subject of this chapter is the resurrection of the dead. In particular, they wanted to know what body they came out of the grave with. This was the issue Paul was addressing. Finally, he gets to it directly.

Go down to verse 33:

Be not deceived: evil communications corrupt good manners. Awake to righteousness, and sin not; for some have not the knowledge of God: I speak this to your shame.

Why, Paul? Just because we do not understand all these things?

He says one man will ask:

How are the dead raised up? and with what body do they come?

Paul takes several verses to explain it. Verse 36 says:

Thou fool, that which thou sowest is not quickened, except it die.

I could think of better words to call my ignorance, but Paul says, "Thou fool."

He continues:

And that which thou sowest, thou sowest not that body that shall be, but bare grain, it may chance of wheat, or of some other grain: but God giveth it a body as it hath pleased him, and to every seed his own body.

What he is telling you is this: you wonder where your glorified body comes from. Look at the bare grain. It does not look like the body that is to come, but you can be sure the program in the DNA is there for the body.

That is why he says unless the grain dies, it will not be quickened. If it is quickened, you do not yet know what body it will have. Eventually you will see it, because it was in the DNA and program of the seed.

Then Paul goes into the glory of one celestial body and the glory of another. The point he is getting across is that yours is sown a natural body and raised a spiritual or glorified body. The glory of the difference between the one sown and the one you are going to have is as different as night and day.

The Spiritual Body Comes From Incorruptible Seed

What finally broke this whole chapter open for me is verse 44:

It is sown a natural body; it is raised a spiritual body. There is a natural body, and there is a spiritual body.

The way we have usually broken this down is to say there is a natural body, this one, and there is a spiritual body, the one currently living in this natural body. But that is not what Paul was talking about.

When the Lord first started breaking this chapter down by giving me that key verse, He said, "Look, it is sown a natural body, but it will be raised a spiritual body adapted for the world which is to come."

I wondered whether the Greek caught that. So I got my Greek books down, which I have been informed by several people are lacking. That is all right. I do not depend on them for a final say-so. Most of the time, when He gives me something, it gets proven even by people who can take the Greek and the languages further. Sometimes the set I have is incorrect.

So I thought, "They are never going to get this one." He is talking about a natural body, the one sown, and a spiritual body, the one that will be glorified or resurrected.

I opened it up, and they said, in effect, "He seems to be talking about our glorified body, which will be adapted to the world to come when it is risen."

I thought, "Of all the ones to get, they got one that most do not get."

So he says it is sown a natural body and raised a spiritual body.

When was it really sown? Romans 6. I was baptized into His death so that I might also be quickened with Him in His resurrection. When I was baptized into His death, the old man died. I was sown then. I was quickened together, born again of incorruptible seed.

You do not know what body is to come, but you can rest assured: the seed I was born again of has a glorified body in its DNA. That is what will give me my glorified body, whether He took it out of the grave that day, or whether I am standing in front of you and we are glorified looking at each other, or whether you are coming through the clouds and suddenly get glorified.

It is all going to come from the same place. He does not need the DNA from your old body.

Paul answers the question in the next few verses. It is sown a natural body; it is raised a spiritual body.

Verse 45 confirms it:

And so it is written, The first man Adam was made a living soul; the last Adam was made a quickening spirit.

My life came from Adam: spirit, soul, and body from one single strand of DNA. But the last Adam was made a quickening, life-giving Spirit.

Verse 46:

Howbeit that was not first which is spiritual, but that which is natural; and afterward that which is spiritual.

Verse 47:

The first man is of the earth, earthy: the second man is the Lord from heaven.

As is the earthy, such are they also that are earthy, because Adam gave them their spirit, soul, and body. As is the heavenly, such are they also that are heavenly.

And as we have borne the exact image of the earthy, spirit, soul, and body, we shall also, at the sound of the trump, bear the exact image of the second Man, the heavenly.

Why? Because I have been born again of incorruptible seed. My glorified body is contained within the DNA of my new birth.

If I was eaten by a shark, I am still going to be glorified. If I was cremated, I am still going to be glorified. If I was blown up by an atomic bomb, I am still going to be glorified.

Christ Returns With Saints Who Still Receive Bodily Completion

Are you ready to take this a little further? You would not stone me if I came up to the edge of Thessalonians, would you?

Go to 1 Thessalonians. First, look at 3:13. We are going to establish something.

While you are going over there, I will read Jude 14:

And Enoch also, the seventh from Adam, prophesied of these, saying, Behold, the Lord cometh with ten thousands of his saints.

First Thessalonians 3:13 says:

To the end he may stablish your hearts unblameable in holiness before God, even our Father, at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ with all his saints.

If I stepped out of my body now, my spirit would immediately go to be in His presence and run around heaven, having a good time. Then I would return back with Him to come and get you.

That is fine. Paul establishes that He is coming back with us. Yet as we get down into chapter 4, he says the dead in Christ shall rise first, and we who are alive and remain shall be caught up.

If we are coming back with Him, how are we going to rise?

Do these things bother you, or do you ever think that far?

Somebody says, "Well, I do not have to answer every question. We can just have faith and believe He will do it."

Yes, but He gave this to us to understand. Understanding speaks of greater fellowship with Him than stepping back, not understanding, and admiring your faith for being able to believe Him when you cannot understand what He says.

We have established in 1 Thessalonians 3:13 that at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ, He comes with all His saints.

Now in chapter 4, he uses the same kind of language as in 1 Corinthians 15: "I would not have you ignorant." Paul seems to be addressing this problem in particular concerning the resurrection.

Verse 13 says:

But I would not have you to be ignorant, brethren, concerning them which are asleep, that ye sorrow not, even as others which have no hope.

Your loved ones had died as time went by. Paul testified in Corinthians that Jesus was seen by more than five hundred brethren, the greater part of whom remained, but some had fallen asleep. They were losing friends and relatives, and there was much persecution. Paul is assuring them.

He is saying, in the same language, "Do not be ignorant concerning those who died before you." Whatever he says here is supposed to be comforting.

Notice closely:

For if we believe that Jesus died and rose again, even so them also which sleep in Jesus will God bring with him.

Again, what would he be talking about? Chapter 3:13 says He comes with all His saints. Jude says He comes with ten thousands of His saints. Here Paul says those who sleep in Jesus, God will bring with Him.

Then verse 15:

For this we say unto you by the word of the Lord, that we which are alive and remain unto the coming of the Lord shall not prevent them which are asleep.

A better word for "prevent" is "precede." Some of your King James Bibles may even have that in the margin. The closest rendering would be "precede" or "go before."

What is he saying?

We who are alive and remain unto the coming of the Lord will not precede those who have slept before us in the glorification. We will not precede them.

Verse 16:

For the Lord himself shall descend from heaven with a shout, with the voice of the archangel, and with the trump of God: and the dead in Christ shall rise first.

This is where all the controversy has come from: "the dead in Christ shall rise first."

If they are returning with Him, how can they be rising here?

We are alive in Christ and will not precede them. They will go before us in the glorification. Then verse 17 addresses us:

Then we which are alive and remain shall be caught up together with them in the clouds, to meet the Lord in the air: and so shall we ever be with the Lord.

To meet Him in the air: a flying body.

Death Is Swallowed Up When the Whole Man Is Glorified

Go back to 1 Corinthians 15 and see how Paul describes this happening. What does he mean by the dead in Christ rising? Is he talking about their bodies jumping out? What exactly is happening, especially if someone was blown up by a bomb?

How can the dead be rising when those who slept in Him are coming with Him?

I like the end of this chapter, when Paul talks about the moment in the twinkling of an eye when we are glorified. Verse 52 says:

In a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trump.

That is the trump he described in Thessalonians.

For the trumpet shall sound, and the dead shall be raised incorruptible, and we shall be changed.

Then he says, in reference to us:

For this corruptible must put on incorruption, and this mortal must put on immortality.

When the corruptible shall have put on incorruption and the mortal shall have put on immortality, then shall be brought to pass the saying that is written:

Death is swallowed up in victory.

You have to understand this statement: in our dispensation, our resurrection from the dead is not complete until the final enemy is put down, which is death.

The resurrection he is talking about here, and if you went into the original that references the original, is the death of the body being swallowed up in victory. That happens when the death of the body is finally conquered at the end of this dispensation and the whole man is raised: not just spirit, but soul and body also.

So when he said the dead in Christ will rise first, he meant those who slept before you will be the first ones to experience the completion of the resurrection from the dead by receiving their glorified bodies just moments before you do.

Something like this is going to happen. You will be going around, hopefully not watching a bad movie. You will hope you are in prayer or something that might sway His decision toward your glorification a little.

I will tell you where you will be: you will be celebrating the victory at Tulsa and moving on to other cities.

When he says the dead in Christ will rise first, he is talking about the final victory of death being swallowed up in victory, and the completion of the whole man in Christ: spirit, soul, and body. We will not precede those who slept in Christ. He is going to do them first and us second.

That is all right. We are the ones still running around with everybody. We had to wait for the last moment. Then, all of a sudden, gone in a moment.

There was a book called *Gone in a Moment*. Some of it was a little silly, with gold teeth and fillings left piled in airplane seats, but the point is that two will be in the field and one will be taken. The whole world is going to know something happened.

At the end of the first advent, the whole world did not see it. But when this is the final victory, when death is swallowed up in victory, the whole world will know something happened because He is going to pluck us from the surface. There will be a whole lot of people who went to a reunion they were not invited to, or did not accept an invitation to.

Something like this is going to happen. We will be standing there worshiping God, getting somebody saved, and all of a sudden there will be a blast of a trump. In the spirit you will look up. How could you help it? You will see Jesus.

In our dispensation, it will be the saints who belong to ours coming back with Him. You will be looking up, and all your relatives will be there. At first you will not be able to see anything else. The blast of the trump will take place, and after the trump you will look up and see Him.

You will not yet be able to see all your relatives glorified, because they are not glorified yet, unless you had some before the cross. But all of a sudden, in the clouds, while you are looking, you will see all those saints who returned with Him suddenly have death swallowed up in victory. They will be glorified right in front of you by the millions.

When they are done, suddenly you will be glorified and caught up in the clouds with them for the greatest reunion in history.

If your life was blown up by a bomb, it does not matter. When you come through at the end of the dispensation and He gets the rest of the family, the last stage of your DNA is kicking in. It does not matter if you have a natural body or not. It is all going to come from the same place when it goes supernatural.

Hallelujah.

The Final Victory Publicly Completes What Began in the New Birth

Now think about the first advent. It is not documented all over the world. In our advent, our dispensation, believers have been dying since the cross. A few travelers have ventured into heaven, full of God, and come back to report that it is a real place. They have testified to the rest of the world, but the rest of the world had to receive it on their say-so.

There are even signs and wonders in our midst, resurrection of the dead in the natural, and the whole world still looks on unbelieving. They assume there is some way to disprove it if somebody would just take the time.

Sometimes a child will be healed right in front of somebody's eyes, with ten doctors watching, a child all twisted up who had never walked or seen or done anything. Then people will go away thinking they were hypnotized or duped.

They will go to any length not to believe what happened.

So in His first resurrection, there is not much record except what is preached and received by faith, and the signs and wonders recorded among us. At the end of that first advent, the group involved with His resurrection went down, were seen, and testified. The rest of the world had to have been glorified like the saints that went before: up in the clouds at Jesus' ascension, except for that one group.

But with us, when death is swallowed up in victory, when we possess the image of the second Adam spirit, soul, and body as we possessed the image of the first, then comes the final victory over the death caused by the first man's fall.

We will receive our glorified bodies because the DNA for them is in the incorruptible seed by which we have been born again.

Paul goes into a strong discourse in the first half of 1 Corinthians 15 about death being swallowed up in victory. At the end, he is talking about us who are alive and remain being quickened.

Thessalonians says we will not precede them. Their death will be swallowed up in final victory before ours will. Then we will be glorified, leave this planet for a while, and have that great reunion.

You will see Him. All your friends will be glorified. Then you will look at each other and know you had better hang on, because He is coming.

Hallelujah.

All right. We got through it.